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SI 338
Client Project Deliverable 4

Link to GitHub project: https://github.com/lilyhigg/338mobile
Link to deliverable site: https://lilyhigg.github.io/338mobile/

Project Explanation

For this project, I was tasked with creating a website to showcase a cross country athlete's running career. I was given data for each race the athlete competed in, including times, placements, and photos of the athlete in action. Using this information, I was asked to design a site where visitors could explore the athlete's performance history and learn more about their career.

To approach this project, I chose to design an image-focused homepage. This allows viewers to immediately see the athlete in action before accessing detailed statistics. Users can click a button to reveal additional information and race data. This layout helps put a face to the name and humanizes the athlete, rather than presenting only performance statistics.

The site also includes a biography section that introduces the athlete, including their grade, school, and a brief overview of their running career. This provides context and helps visitors better understand the athlete's background and accomplishments.

Rubric Elements

Mobile First Design

I followed a mobile-first design approach by regularly testing the website on my phone throughout the development process. This allowed me to make adjustments in real time to ensure the layout and content displayed properly on smaller screens. I made sure the text was large enough to be easily readable on mobile devices and that buttons and other touch targets were appropriately sized for users to tap comfortably.

Additionally, I used CSS Grid to organize the photos in a two-column layout. This prevented the screen from feeling overcrowded while still displaying multiple images at once. The layout also supports smooth scrolling, making it easier for users to navigate the page and view content without feeling overwhelmed.

I also implemented light and dark mode media queries so the site adapts to the user's device settings. This improves readability and ensures a comfortable viewing experience regardless of lighting conditions. Additionally, I incorporated iconography to make the content more visually engaging and appealing. The use of icons helps break up text, draw attention to key information, and enhance the overall user experience.

CSS Quality

While writing my CSS, I focused on keeping the file organized and easy to navigate. I structured the stylesheet based on the order the elements appear on the page. At the top, I included general styling for the HTML and body. This was followed by navigation styles, the header section containing the athlete's details, the main content section displaying meet information, and then the footer styles. I placed the media queries at the end of the file. Organizing the CSS this way makes it easier to locate and update specific sections when changes are needed.

I also formatted each CSS rule consistently to improve readability. I paid close attention to repetitive code and worked to eliminate unnecessary duplication to keep the file clean and efficient. Finally, I added detailed comments throughout the stylesheet to explain what each section does and why it is necessary, making the code easier to understand and maintain.

Animations

I added several animations to the website to improve the user experience.

The first animation applies to the "Skip to Main Content" link. When users press the Tab key, the link smoothly swoops into view at the top of the screen, making it easy to see and select.

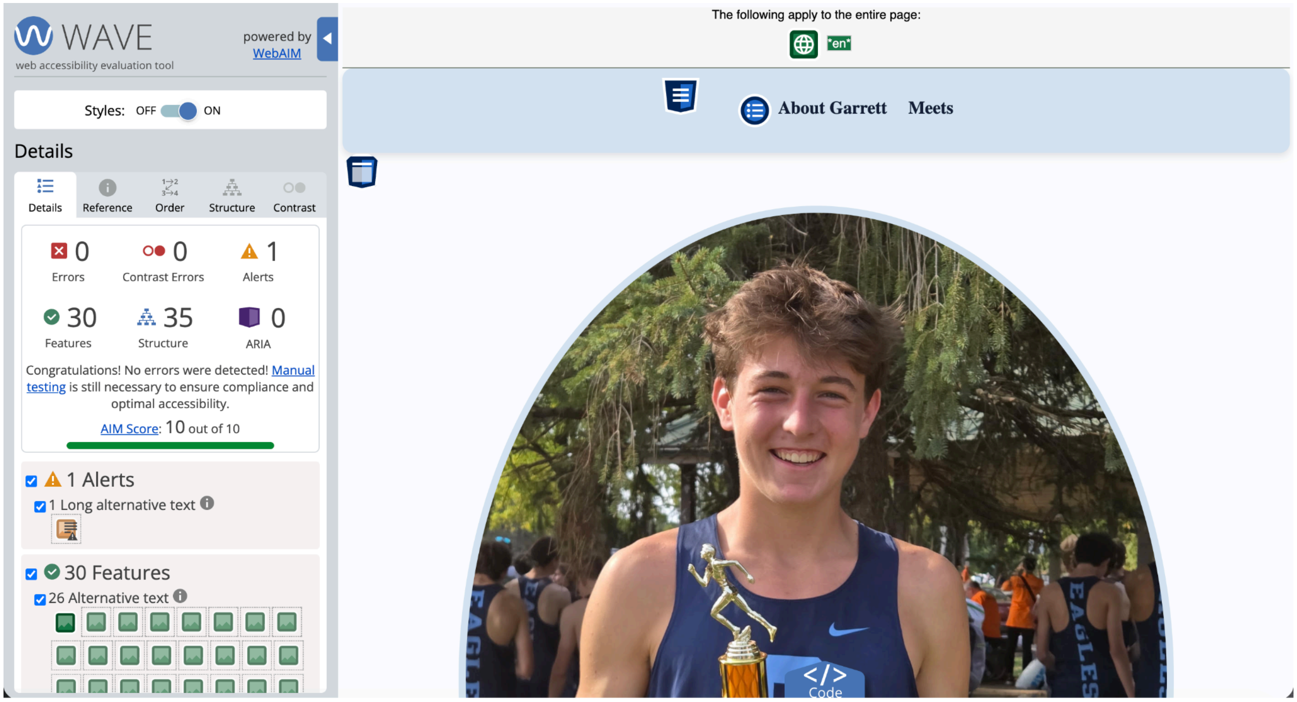
The second animation affects the navigation links. When users click a nav link, the page smoothly scrolls to the corresponding section. This provides a visual cue that helps users understand where they have been taken on the page.

Another animation occurs when users click on an image. The image gradually expands on the screen, allowing users to view a larger version more clearly.

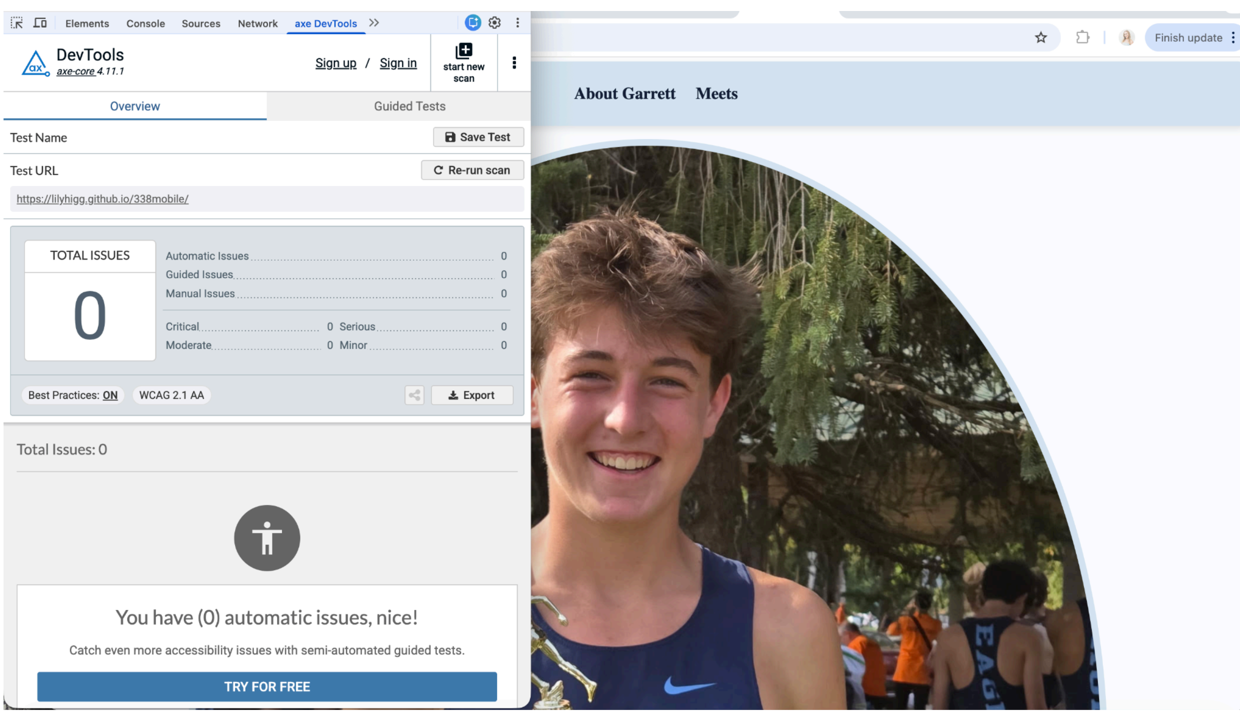
In addition, the "More Info" buttons include a selected state. When clicked, the button changes to a light blue color to clearly indicate that it has been activated.

Finally, I implemented a media query that detects when users have enabled reduced motion in their system settings. When this preference is active, all animations are disabled to ensure a more accessible and comfortable experience.

Passes WAVE Validation



Passes aXe Validation



Addresses Prefers-Reduced Preference

I implemented media queries to detect when users have Reduced Motion enabled in their system settings, ensuring a more accessible and comfortable browsing experience by disabling animations when that preference is active.

Addresses User’s Color Scheme Preference

I implemented media queries to detect when users have Dark Mode enabled in their system settings. When this preference is active, the website automatically adjusts its color scheme to better support users’ contrast preferences and light sensitivity needs. By default, the website displays in light mode.

No Console Errors

I thoroughly tested the website using the browser’s developer tools to ensure there were no console errors. I checked for broken links, missing assets, and accessibility warnings, resolving any issues that appeared. This helped ensure the site runs smoothly, loads correctly, and provides a reliable experience for users across different browsers and devices.

Presentation and Clarity

I made sure that both my code and written deliverable were clear, organized, and professional. In my code, I used consistent formatting, proper indentation, and helpful comments where necessary to improve readability and maintainability. I also structured my files logically so that each section was easy to navigate.

For the written deliverable, I focused on clarity, organization, and concise explanations. I used clear headings, structured paragraphs, and straightforward language to ensure my ideas were easy to follow. Together, these efforts ensure that my work is both technically sound and professionally presented.